

Lean Management Techniques

Hints and Tips

Unit 3



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Hints and Tips Unit 3

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit three: Working in business teams

Section 1 - Making an effective team

Q1. Name and describe three characteristics of an effective team.

Make sure that you describe three characteristics of an effective team, don't just name them. You should try and think about any teams that you've been a part of in the past and what made them effective as this will help you come up with three characteristics.

Remember, there are ten characteristics of effective and ineffective teams to choose from, which were originally derived from McGregor's findings. You only need to identify and describe three of these characteristics in your answer. The characteristics of an effective team are not to be confused with the seven key steps that allow team members to know what their goals are.

Q2. Using the table below, describe three different types of team structure and give an example for each.

You must provide three different types of team structure for this question. Remember that teams are made up of members with particular roles, as defined by the BELBIN approach. Team members also have different behavioural styles, skills and capabilities which help the team to achieve its objectives.

Q3. Explain the benefits of team working using one of the scenarios below

You should look over the course content to remind yourself of some of the benefits of team working but you must make sure your explanations are in your own words.

Section 2 - Working effectively in a team

Q1. Complete the table below. List two existing conflicts or difficult situations and two potential conflicts or difficult situations that you can identify from the case study.

Considering the four categories of potential difficulties (purpose, roles, relationships and processes) will help to answer this question. Make sure you come up with two potential and two existing situations.

Q2. How would a team member deal with each of these conflicts or difficult situations? Identify ways to overcome these in the table below.

This question asks you to identify ways a team member could deal with each of the conflicts that you identified in Q1. Make sure you provide four different actions in your answer. Also, be careful not to get Q2 and Q3 mixed up. Also, take note that Q2 is about team members and Q3 is about team leaders.

Q3. Team members and team leaders have different roles and responsibilities. The skills, qualities, attitudes, characteristics and communication methods needed by a team leader in a situation of conflict will be different to that of a team member. How would a team leader deal with each of the four conflicts and difficult situations that you identified from the case study above?

This question asks you to identify ways a team leader could deal with each of the conflicts that you identified in Q1. Make sure you provide four different actions in your answer.

Q4. Complete the tables to show which two people are the most effective team members and which two are the least effective.

You have to imagine yourself in the role of monitor evaluator as outlined in Belbin's Team Role Theory. You should think about the objectives of the team detailed in the case study and consider how well each team member contributes to those objectives.

Q5. What changes could the least effective team members do to improve effectiveness in any future team activity?

You should suggest changes that the least effective team members could make which would improve effectiveness in any future team activity. In this example the least effective team members are Grace Harvey and Hector Chan.

Section 3 – The role of team leader

Q1. What are the managerial competences needed by a team leader? Name and describe the 7 managerial competences in the boxes below.

Make sure that you describe the seven managerial competencies needed by a team leader, don't just name them. You could try thinking about any team leaders you've worked with in the past and what made them competent.

Q2. Complete the table below by describing four of the personal qualities needed by a team leader using examples from the scenario provided.

For this question you must come up with four personal qualities. Make sure that you use examples from the scenario provided in your answer.

Q3. Complete the table below by identifying ways that a team leader could motivate team members in each of the scenarios below.

This question asks you to identify ways a team leader could motivate team members. Your answer should cover all three of the scenarios provided. Try and imagine yourself in the role of team leader and how you would try and motivate the team members in each scenario.